

→ Planning: in AI is about decision making tasks performed by robots or comp. to achieve a specific goal.

↓

execution = seq. of actions $\Rightarrow$ $\uparrow$ likelihood of task completion.

Classical Planning Environment = full observable, deterministic, finite, static & discrete

others = non-classical

↳ diff set of algo & agent designs

→ Real world problems are nearly decomposable[?]

↓

large complex problems $\Rightarrow$ into smaller subproblems

? $\rightarrow$ subgoals are solved independently by planner
 $\Rightarrow$ largely independent but may interfere

→ Planning systems need a way to describe problems

⇒ Expressive but Restrictive

↓
describe wide
variety of probs.

↳ to allow algos
to operate over it

STRIPS : STanford Research Inst Problem Solver

↑ basic rep. lang for classic planners.

Components of STRIPS

↓
Set of States

= conj of positive
ground literals

$At(Home) \wedge Have(Banana)$

describes current world using facts = True

↓
Goals

= partially
specified state rep
as conj of literals

* can have variables

$At(Home) \wedge \sim$
 $Have(Banana)$

$At(x) \wedge$
 $Sell(x, Banana)$

↓
Actions

↓
Precondition

condn. that need
to be True
before Action

↓
Effect

how world
changes
after action

Action: Buy(x)

Precondition:

$At(p), Sell(p, x)$

Effect: Have(x)

Challenges of AI & Planning:

- ① Closed world Assumption - assumes that the world model contains everything that the robot needs to know; no surprise
- ② Framing Problem: how to represent a real world situation in a way that is computationally tractable (Expressive + Restrictive)

Planning with State Space Search



Forward
(Progression)



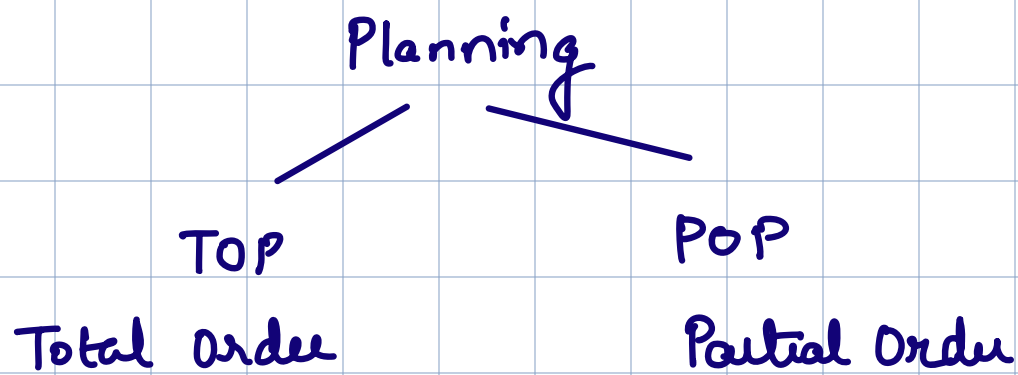
Backward
(Regression)

Initial State

Actions

Goal Test

Step Cost



Total Order Planning : only explore linear seq. of action from start $\rightarrow$ goal.
 $\Rightarrow$ Cannot take advantage of problem decomposition

Partial Order Planning : works on prob decomposition
 $\Rightarrow$ i.e. divide problem into parts & achieve the subgoals independently
 $\Rightarrow$ solve subproblems with subplans $\Rightarrow$ combine + reorder on basis of goal req.
 $\Rightarrow$ does not specify which action will come out first of the 2 that are placed.

POP

Planning — State
— goal
— Action — Pre
— Eff

Eg: Putting on Pair of Shoes

Goal: Right Shoe On $\wedge$ Left Shoe On

Action:

① Right Shoe

Precondition: Right Sock On

Effect: Right Shoe On

② Left Shoe

Precondition: Left Sock On

Effect: Left Shoe On

③ Right Sock

Precondition: None

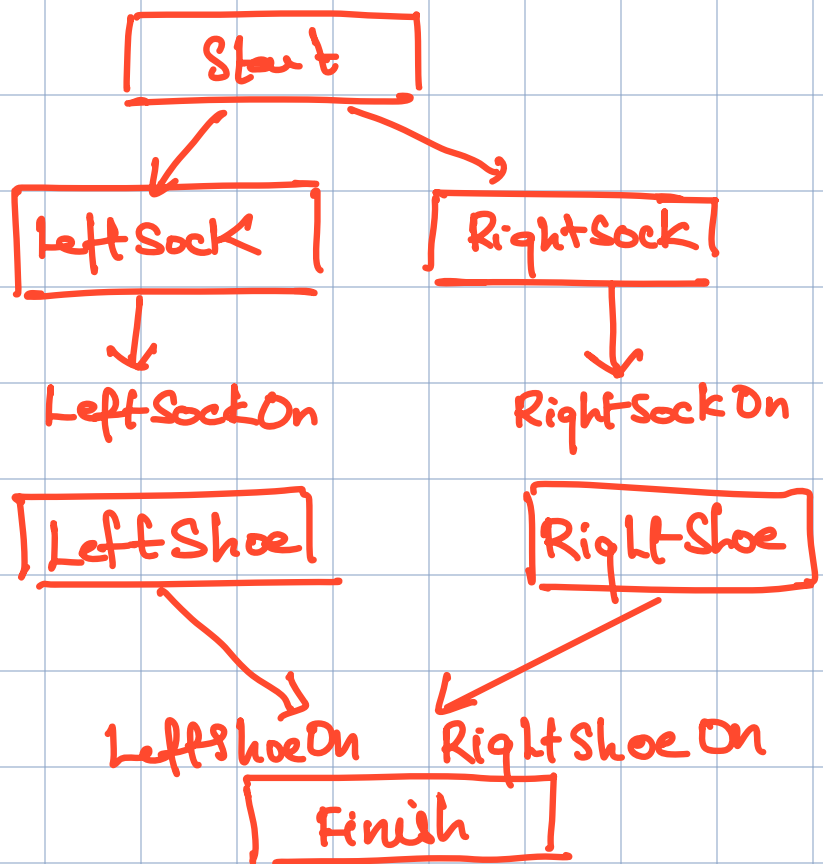
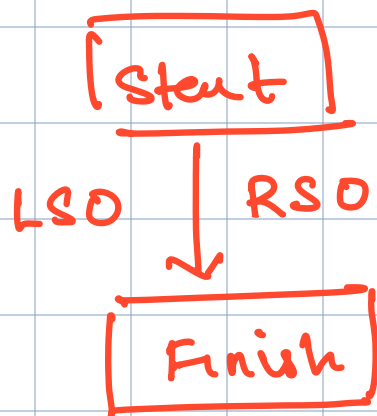
Effect: Right Sock On

④ Left Sock

Precondition: None

Effect: Left Sock On

POP



TOP (6 diff. plans)



Rsock

LSo

RSO

LSO

RSO

LSock

RSO

LSo

LSH

RSh

LShoe

RSh

RSh

RSO

LSO

Right Shoe



Finish

RShoe

LSh

LSh

RSh

LSh

* POP & Hinearchical look similar but

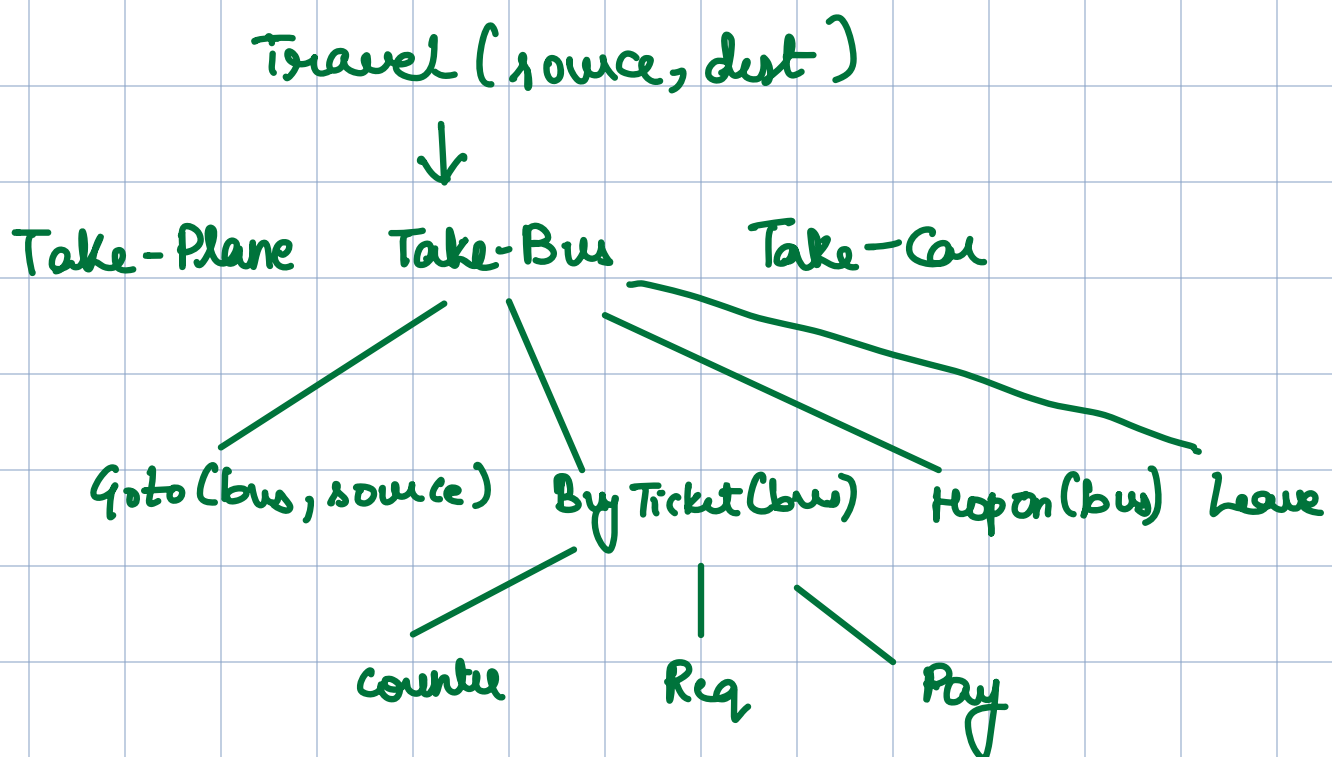
⇒ POP = breaking goal → subgoals Shoes On $\begin{cases} \text{RSo} \\ \text{LSO} \end{cases}$

⇒ Hinearchical = abstract → lower level

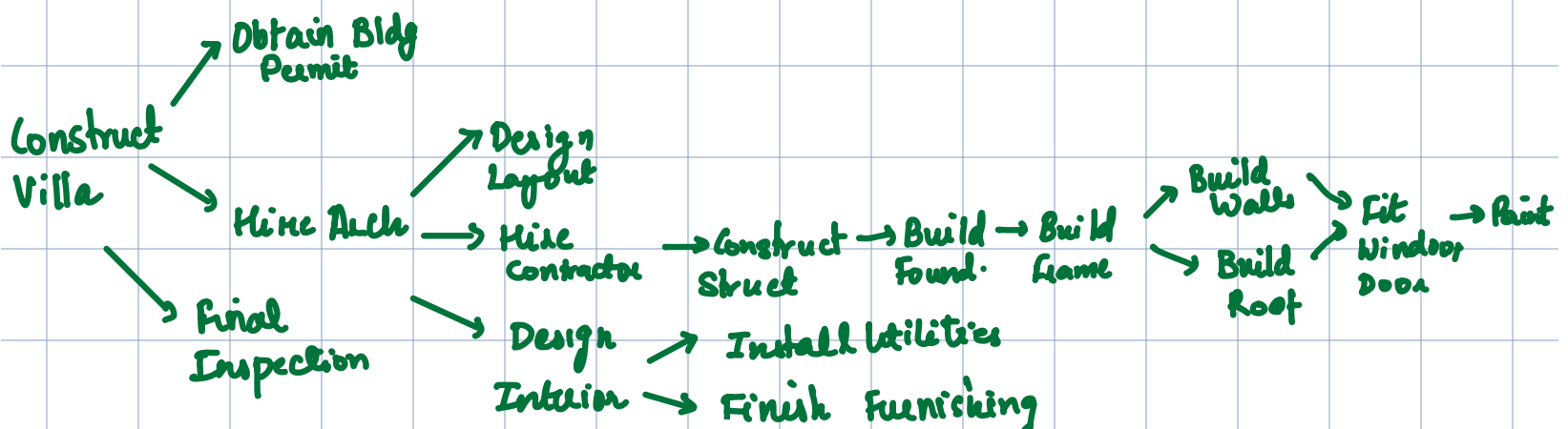
Travel $\begin{cases} \text{Tby Bus} \\ \text{Tby Train} \\ \text{Tby Car} \end{cases}$

Hierarchical Planning

- ⇒ Plans are organized in hierarchical format
- ⇒ works on decomposition



eg: Construct villa after bying land



Conditional Planning

as contingency branches

↳ work regardless of outcome of the action

↳ deals with uncertainty by determining what happens in env. at predetermined points in plan

↳ fully observable + non-deterministic → same action → diff outcomes

↳ I/p action ⇒ should handle every outcome

Classic fails

- Action fail
- uncertainties in env
- outcome not as predicted

Contingent Planning

↳ work under partial observability with sensing agents, that sense meaningful facts

* Conditional = uncertain conseq. (branches created by outcomes)

Contingent = uncertain conditions (branches created by condn.)

STRIPS v/s ADL

①

②

③

④

⑤

⑥

SR. NO.	PARAMETERS	STRIPS	<u>ADL</u>
1	Stands for	STanford Research Institute Problem Solver	Action Description Language
2	Literals allowed in states	Only Positive. E.g.: Intelligent $\wedge$ Beautiful	Positive as well as Negative. E.g.: $\sim$ Stupid $\wedge$ $\sim$ Ugly
3	Assumption for Unmentioned Literals	Closed World Assumptions: Unmentioned literals are False	Open World Assumptions: Unmentioned literals are Unknown
4	Equality	No Support	Equality predicate ($x=y$) is Built-in
5	Types	No Support	Supported. Variables can have types $\rightarrow p:Person$
6	Effects	Effects are conjunctions	Conditional Effects allowed (when P:E)
7	Effect $P \wedge \sim Q$ means:	Add P & Delete Q	Add $P \wedge \sim Q$ Delete $\sim P \wedge Q$
8	Goals	Goals are conjunctions	Allows conjunctions & disjunctions: $\sim Poor \wedge (Famous \vee Smart)$
9	Goals	Only ground literals	Quantified Variables
10	Schema includes	Action name Parameter list Precondition Effect	Action name Parameter list (optional) Groups of clauses labelled: Precond, Add, Delete and Update (optional)
11	Modelling actions in real world applications	Not Suitable	Suitable (This inadequacy of STRIPS led to development of ADL)

Consider an agent that delivers parcels from a warehouse to a customer within a specified time window /chosen time slot. a. Identify and explain the key uncertainties the agent may encounter during the delivery process. b. Propose two alternative delivery plans that account for the uncertainties identified above. c. List and explain the major causes of uncertainty.

a) Key Uncertainties During Delivery Process

A parcel-delivery agent may face several uncertainties:

1. Traffic Conditions

- Roads may become congested unexpectedly.
- Causes delay in reaching destination.

2. Weather Conditions

- Rain, storms, fog, etc. may slow travel.
- Can affect road safety and speed.

3. Customer Availability

- Customer may not be present during delivery.
- Delivery attempt may fail.

4. Vehicle Issues

- Breakdown, low fuel, flat tire, etc.
- Prevents timely delivery.

5. Incorrect / Changing Address Information

- Customer may provide wrong address or request last-minute change.

6. Route Blockages

- Construction, accidents, road closures.

b) Two Alternative Delivery Plans Accounting for Uncertainty

Plan 1: Standard Route with Backup Route

1. Start delivery via shortest planned route
2. Monitor traffic/weather
3. If route blocked or delayed:
 - Switch to alternate route
4. Deliver parcel within time slot

Handles: Traffic, road closures, weather delays

Plan 2: Pre-Delivery Confirmation + Delivery Attempt

1. Contact customer before dispatch
2. Confirm availability and address
3. Start delivery
4. If customer unavailable:
 - Deliver to neighbor/safe locker OR reschedule
5. Update delivery system

Handles: Customer absence, wrong address, failed delivery

3. Partial Observability / Information Uncertainty

Agent lacks complete knowledge.

Examples:

- Doesn't know if customer is home
- Doesn't know real-time road status initially

4. Dynamic Environment

Environment changes during execution.

Examples:

- Sudden accidents
- New delivery instructions from customer

Final Exam-Style Summary

A parcel delivery agent operates in an uncertain and dynamic environment where factors such as traffic, weather, customer availability, and vehicle reliability can affect successful delivery. To manage this uncertainty, the agent can employ contingency-based delivery plans such as alternate route selection and pre-delivery customer confirmation. The major causes of uncertainty include environmental factors, nondeterministic action outcomes, partial observability, and dynamic environmental changes.

map uncertainty to these:

* Observability

↓
Fully
(Classic &
Cond'n)

knows
complete
env

↓
Partial
(Contingent)

* Deterministic

↓
Classic

action
has many
↓ outcomes

Non

↓
Cond'n &
Contingent

* Dynamicity

↓
Static

↓
Dynamic

Planning v/s Searching

*Types of Learning from Notes